

YTD Email Performance Analysis

July 2024 – December 2025 | 3,221 campaigns | 5 brands

Executive Summary

The bottom line: Triggered campaigns outperform batch 4.6x on clicks. Every blast campaign competes against this benchmark.

Key Insights

- 1. Triggered beats batch 4.6x** — 2.52% click rate vs 0.54% for batch sends
- 2. "You/Your" in subjects wins** — +2.2pt open rate, 2.7x more common in top performers
- 3. Holiday tentpoles underperform** — July 4th (-0.58pt), Christmas (-0.36pt), BFCM (-0.16pt)
- 4. August is the sleeper month** — 1.72% click rate, highest of any month
- 5. Fewer links = more clicks** — 0-2 links gets 92% higher clicks than 2-5 links

Part 1: Portfolio Overview

Brand Performance Comparison

Brand	Campaigns	Open Rate	Click Rate	Click-to-Open	Insight
HAV	937	52.5%	1.29%	2.5%	Best opens; editorial works
CZ	708	47.7%	1.16%	2.4%	Personalization is key
STF	403	44.2%	1.48%	3.3%	Highest clicks; product-focused
BUR	412	42.2%	0.34%	0.8%	Content problem (opens but no clicks)
ID	755	34.4%	0.71%	2.1%	List quality problem (improving)

Diagnosis: - **BUR** has a *content* problem — 42% open rate but only 0.8% click-to-open means people open but don't engage - **ID** has a *list quality* problem — 34% opens with normal click-to-open suggests deliverability or list issues

Triggered vs Batch: The Benchmark

Type	Campaigns	Sends	Open Rate	Click Rate
Triggered	74	156K	53.8%	2.52%
Batch	3,294	299M	44.4%	0.54%

Every batch campaign should be measured against the 2.52% triggered benchmark. Cart abandonment, browse abandonment, and post-purchase flows consistently outperform.

Campaign Type Performance

Type	Campaigns	Click Rate	Unsub Rate	Verdict
Editorial	397	0.74%	0.16%	Best batch type
Product Launch	267	0.69%	0.13%	Strong
Sale/Promo	671	0.58%	0.16%	Average
Reminder	793	0.39%	0.16%	Overused
Other	1,166	0.53%	0.15%	Baseline

Insight: Editorial content gets 1.9x higher clicks than reminders. "Last chance" messaging is fatigued.

Part 2: Cross-Brand Patterns

Timing

Best Day by Brand

Brand	Best Day	Click Rate	Worst Day	Click Rate
STF	Monday	1.08%	Thursday	0.81%
CZ	Monday	1.07%	Thursday	0.88%
HAV	Wednesday	1.07%	Sunday	0.37%
ID	Wednesday	0.57%	Thursday	0.48%
BUR	Tuesday	0.26%	Friday	0.21%

All times Eastern Time (ET)

Pattern: CZ & STF perform best on Monday. HAV & ID perform best Wednesday.

Seasonal Performance

Quarter	Click Rate	Insight
Q3 (Jul-Sep)	1.19%	Best quarter — back-to-school
Q1 (Jan-Mar)	0.94%	New year momentum
Q4 (Oct-Dec)	0.83%	Holiday fatigue
Q2 (Apr-Jun)	0.63%	Summer slump

Best month: August (1.72%) **Worst month:** June (0.54%)

Holiday Tentpole Performance

Period	Click Rate	vs 0.95% Baseline
Labor Day	1.01%	+0.05pt
Black Friday/Cyber	0.80%	-0.16pt
Christmas/Holiday	0.59%	-0.36pt
July 4th	0.38%	-0.58pt

Critical insight: Every major tentpole underperforms baseline. Inbox competition during holidays hurts engagement.

Subject Lines

What Works

Pattern	Impact	Verdict
You/Your	+2.2pt open	Use it
Exclamation (!)	+1.5pt open	Slight help

What Doesn't

Pattern	Impact	Verdict
Contains Number	-2.4pt open	Avoid
Percent (%)	-3.4pt open	Generic discounts fail
Question (?)	-2.7pt open	Avoid
ALL CAPS	-4.4pt open	Never use

Top vs Bottom Performers

Pattern	Top 100	Bottom 100
You/Your	43%	16%
Urgency words	18%	32%
ALL CAPS	21%	34%
Percent (%)	32%	50%

Takeaway: Personalization wins. Urgency and discounts are overused and underperform.

Creative Structure

Image Count

Images	Click Rate	Insight
0-1	1.32%	Best — minimal works
1-2	1.24%	Strong
20+	1.46%	Catalog exception
10-20	0.85%	Too cluttered

Link Count

Links	Click Rate
0-2	1.81%
2-5	0.94%
5-10	0.97%

Rule: Fewer links = more clicks. 0-2 links gets 92% higher clicks than 2-5.

Layout Performance

Layout	Click Rate
Text Only	1.33%
Hero Only	1.13%
Product Grid	0.98%
Editorial	0.90%

Preheader Best Practices

Preheader	Open Rate
With preheader	45.6%
No preheader	36.9%
Difference	+8.7pt

Best length: 60-90 characters (47.6% open rate)

Part 3: Brand Deep Dives

Havenly (HAV)

Profile: 937 campaigns | 52.5% open | 1.29% click

What Works

- **Editorial content** — Hideaway series averages 1.58% click (1.9x batch average)
- **"You/Your" subjects** — +2.6pt open, +0.54pt click

- **Wednesday sends** — 1.07% click rate
- **Hero-only layout** — Clean, focused design

What Doesn't

- Category navigation in emails (0.11% click)
- Urgency words (+1.2pt open but -0.16pt click — opens but doesn't convert)

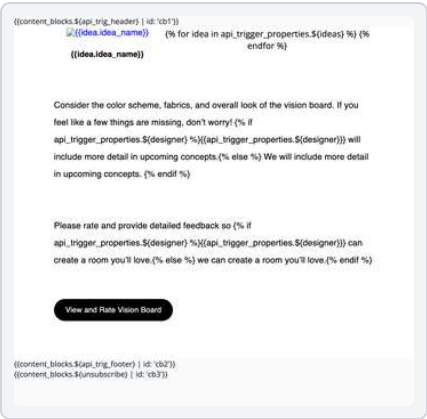
Campaign Types

Type	Click Rate	Count
Editorial	1.47%	170
Merch Sale	0.78%	365
DPS	0.45%	11

Top Performer

Subject: "Your Vision Board is ready!" **Performance:** 16.65% click | 83.4% open | 1,544 sends

Why it works: Personalized, action-oriented, delivers on a promise the user initiated.



Citizenry (CZ)

Profile: 708 campaigns | 47.7% open | 1.16% click

What Works

- **"You/Your" subjects** — +6.8pt open, +0.94pt click (massive impact)
- **Exclamation points** — +5.0pt open
- **Monday sends** — 1.07% click rate
- **Text-only layout** — Personal letter style

What Doesn't

- **ALL CAPS** — -11.6pt open (disaster)

- **Urgency words** — -5.3pt open (backfires for this audience)

Top Performer

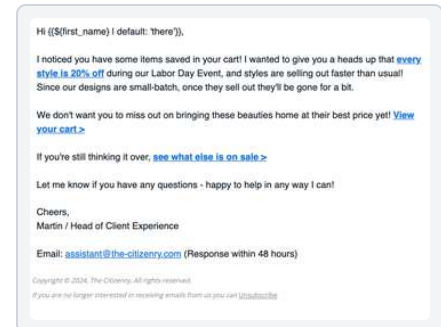
Subject: "Re: Your Cart" **Performance:** 9.97% click | 65.5% open | 1,043 sends

Why it works: Personal tone ("Re:"), triggered by behavior, feels like a response not a broadcast.

Subject: "Elevate Your Bed With This Must-Have Pillow"

Performance: 6.87% click | 60.8% open | 1,004 sends

Why it works: Specific product focus, benefit-driven subject, not a generic sale.



Interior Define (ID)

Profile: 755 campaigns | 34.4% open | 0.71% click

The Problem

ID has a **list quality issue** — low open rates but normal click-to-open ratio (2.1%). The audience that opens engages normally; the problem is getting opens.

Good news: Performance improved significantly mid-2025, suggesting list health initiatives are working.

What Works

- **Wednesday sends** — 0.57% click rate
- **Specific product calls** — "Your dream sofa" vs generic sales
- **4 images** — Sweet spot for this brand (1.80% click)

What Doesn't

- **Emojis** — -6.1pt open (perceived as less premium)
- **Thursday sends** — Worst day (0.48%)

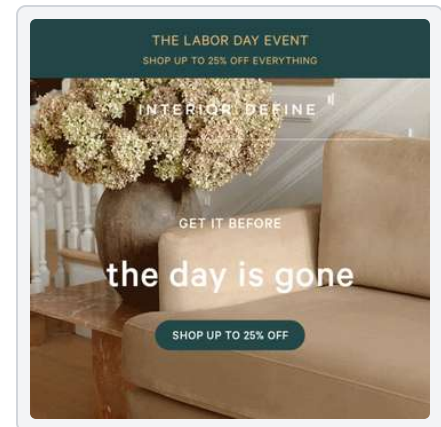
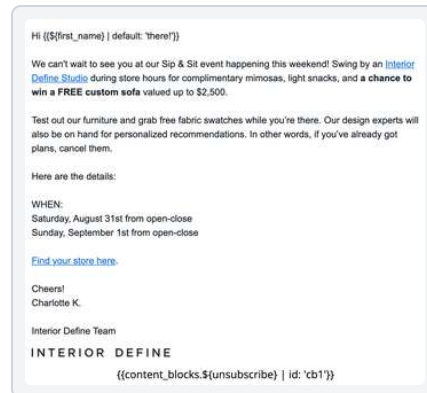
Top Performer

Subject: "Your dream sofa is on sale" **Performance:** 15.76% click | 69.0% open | 3,914 sends

Why it works: Personal ("your"), specific product, sale is secondary to the aspiration.

Subject: "We planned your long weekend" **Performance:** 6.16% click | 64.5% open | 3,671 sends

Why it works: Lifestyle framing, feels helpful not salesy.



Burrow (BUR)

Profile: 412 campaigns | 42.2% open | 0.34% click

The Problem

BUR has a **content problem** — 42% open rate is decent, but 0.8% click-to-open is abysmal. People open emails but don't find anything worth clicking.

What Works

- **Text-only layouts** — 3.20% click vs 0.11% for hero+products (**30x difference**)
- **First-access messaging** — "You're getting first access..." drives 8.6% clicks
- **Deep discounts (70%+)** — Actually motivates action
- **Tuesday sends** — 0.26% click (marginal but best)

What Doesn't

- **Visual campaigns** — Hero+products layout gets 0.11% click
- **Generic 25% off** — 0.1% click rate
- **Exclamation points** — -3.4pt open (opposite of CZ)

Top Performer

Subject: "You're getting first access to exclusive offers, launches, and events" **Performance:** 8.59% click | 66.8% open | 30,011 sends

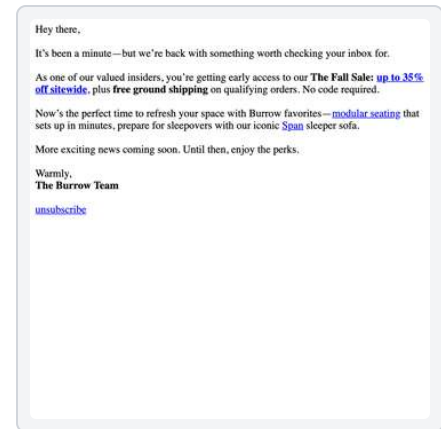
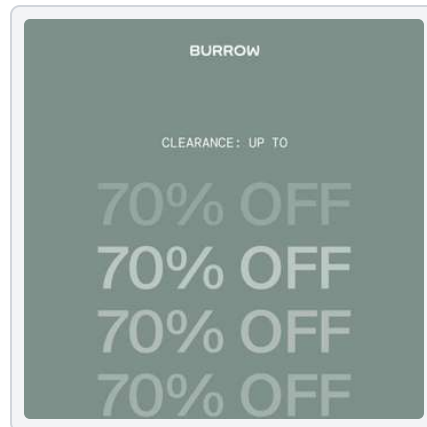
Why it works: VIP framing, promise of exclusivity, welcome/onboarding context.

Subject: "UP TO 70% OFF" **Performance:** 4.37% click | 54.0% open | 44,298 sends

Why it works: Deep discount (70%+) actually motivates. Generic 25% doesn't move this audience.

Recommendation for BUR

Adopt a **personal letter style** — minimal imagery, text-focused, first-access framing. The data strongly suggests BUR's visual campaigns are actively hurting performance.



St Frank (STF)

Profile: 403 campaigns | 44.2% open | **1.48% click** (highest)

What Works

- **Emojis** — +5.5pt open, +0.64pt click (only brand where this works)
- **GIFs** — 1.69% vs 1.28% for static (only brand where GIF wins)
- **Monday sends** — 1.08% click rate
- **Product launches** — "JUST DROPPED" performs well
- **Hero+Products layout** — 4.79% click

What Doesn't

- **Editorial content** — 0.30% click (this audience wants to shop, not read)
- **ALL CAPS** — -4.6pt open
- **Thursday sends** — 0.81% click (worst day)

Top Performer

Subject: "JUST DROPPED: Ombré Lumbars" **Performance:** 9.08% click | 50.5% open | 4,999 sends

Why it works: New arrival urgency, specific product, visual appeal.

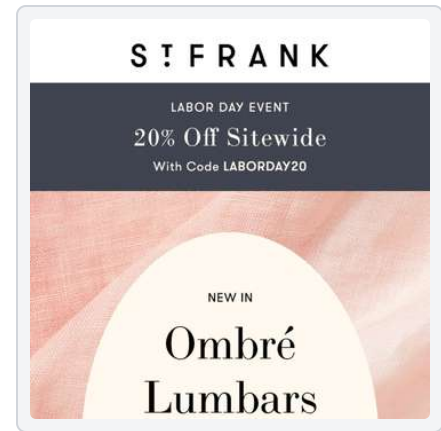
Subject: "On the way! Ready-to-ship styles" **Performance:** 8.03% click | 31.7% open | 4,035 sends

Why it works: Solves a real problem (shipping speed), action-oriented.

Subject: "Bestselling Floral Bedding Is Back"

Performance: 7.56% click | 4,944 sends

Why it works: Back-in-stock urgency, proven bestseller, specific product.



Methodology & Limitations

What This Analysis Can Tell You

- **Correlations** between tactics and performance
- **Patterns** that warrant A/B testing
- **Baseline benchmarks** for comparison
- **Audience differences** between brands

What This Analysis Cannot Tell You

- **Causation** — Correlation is not cause. A tactic may work because it's rare, not inherently better.
- **Novelty effects** — Text-only emails may outperform because they're uncommon. If everyone switched, the advantage would disappear.
- **Sequence effects** — A promo after 5 content emails performs differently than after 5 other promos.
- **Selection bias** — Certain tactics may only be used in specific contexts that inherently perform better.

Recommended Approach

1. **Use findings as hypotheses** — Test before assuming causation
 2. **Consider frequency** — A winning tactic used sparingly beats one used constantly
 3. **Monitor for decay** — What works today may stop working as competitors adopt it
 4. **Segment analysis** — These are averages; high-value segments may behave differently
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Analysis generated December 2025